# THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
# FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

## PMWM7017 Current Topics in Asset Management

**GENERAL INFORMATION**

Instructors: Prof Eric Poon, Mr Mark Cheng, and Prof Fred Chak

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Consultation times: TBD
Course Website: 1c83bf0d92610b6e3371bf9cb41f493e.pdf (not available)
Reference Book: TBD

**COURSE DESCRIPTION**

This course offers a practical exploration of key trends, cutting-edge strategies, and opportunities in the dynamic field of asset management. Designed for future-oriented wealth management professionals, the module emphasizes industry insights into topics such as investors such as family offices, sustainable investing, alternative assets, fintech, and the evolving regulatory landscape.

Through case studies, expert guest speakers, and interactive discussions, students will develop a comprehensive understanding of the shifting global investment environment. Emphasis is placed on evaluating real-world developments and their implications for institutional and private asset managers operating across diverse markets, with a particular focus on Asia.

**COURSE OBJECTIVES**

This course aims to provide students with an in-depth understanding of asset management strategies, exploring the latest trends, innovations, and challenges in asset management, venture capital, private equity and other alternative investment strategies. Through practical analysis of financial trends, portfolio management, product development and emerging asset classes, students will develop practical insights into risk assessment, regulatory changes, and industry best practices. By engaging with real-world case studies and guest speakers' perspectives, participants will be equipped to navigate complex investment landscapes and optimize asset allocation strategies for diverse financial objectives, target wealth management clients, family offices and alike.

**PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES**

PLO1: Acquisition of the techniques and advanced knowledge in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management including but not limited to financial services, technology and law: Students should acquire techniques and advanced knowledge in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management including but not limited to financial services, technology and law.

PLO2: Application and integration of interdisciplinary knowledge and skills to identify and tackle practical problems, and design innovative products and systems with international standards and global vision: Students should be able to apply and integrate interdisciplinary knowledge and skills in the fields of wealth management to identify and tackle problems, and design innovative products and systems with international standards and global vision.

PLO3: Inculcating leadership, professional ethics and competence in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management: Students should demonstrate the capacity to recognise, understand and develop appropriate options in ethical and social issues in the interdisciplinary fields of investment and wealth management. In their learning experiences, they will be working in teams that promote leadership training and development of leadership traits. In addition, they are to adhere to and respect university regulations on academic conduct.

PLO4: Mastering communication skills: Students should be able to articulate in public and be able to make convincing and coherent presentations, write effectively and use specific technical terminology in the interdisciplinary fields of wealth management in contemporary presentation tools context.

**COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES**

| **Course Learning Outcomes** | **Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes** |
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|---|---|
| CLO1: **Identifying and analysing real business trends and dynamics** in asset management related to the wealth management industry. | PLO 1, 2 |
| CLO2: **Making recommendations** to capture business opportunities or reduce business risks based on the current market dynamics | PLO 1, 2, 3, 4 |
| CLO3: Develop a work plan / SOP with an **understanding of regulatory requirements, compliance, ethics, and risk management** in the asset management and private banking business. | PLO 1, 2, 3 |
| CLO4: **Developing research, writing, and presentation skills** related to asset management and private banking topics. | PLO 1, 2, 3, 4 |

**COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES**

| **Course Teaching and Learning Activities** | **Expected Hour** | **Study Load (% of study)** |
|---|---|---|
| T&L1. Interactive lectures | 30 | 23% |
| T&L2. Online forum discussions | 10 | 8% |
| T&L3. Assignments & Tutorials | 50 | 38% |
| T&L4. Lecture preparation & Self-study | 40 | 31% |
| Total | 130 | 100% |

| **Assessment Methods** | **Brief Description (Optional)** | **Weight** | **Aligned Course Learning Outcomes** |
|---|---|---|---|
| A1. In-class & forum participation | Attendance & discussions | 20% | CLO1, 2, 4 |
| A2. Assignments | Effort and accuracy | 40% | CLO1, 2, 3, 4 |
| A3. Final presentation | Effort and accuracy | 40% | CLO1, 2, 4 |
| | Total | 100% | |

**STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT**

**Course Grade Descriptors**

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|---|---|
| A+, A, A- | •Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge<br>•Handling questions professionally<br>•High participation in discussions<br>•Present arguments that have an element of originality<br>•Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the exams with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills<br>•Excellent performance in assignments |
| B+, B, B- | •Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge<br>•Handling questions in a logical way<br>•Good participation in discussions<br>•Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook<br>•Achieve a standard of good performance in the exams with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills<br>•Good performance in assignments |
| C+, C, C- | •Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Fairly address questions as set<br>•Some participation in discussions<br>•Present arguments in a well-structure manner<br>•Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the exams with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills<br>•Acceptable performance in assignments |

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| D+, D | •Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Barely address questions as set<br>•Minimal or no participation in discussions<br>•Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner<br>•Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the exams with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills<br>•Marginally acceptable performance in assignments |
| F | •Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Unable or unwilling to handle questions<br>•Minimal or no participation in discussions<br>•Present arguments poorly<br>•Fail to meet a standard of passing the exams with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills<br>•Poorly performance in assignments |
| **Assessment Rubrics for Participation** | |
| A+, A, A- | •High participation in discussions<br>•Always attend in-class discussions<br>•Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge<br>•Handling questions professionally<br>•Present arguments that have an element of originality<br>•Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone) |
| B+, B, B- | •Good participation in discussions<br>•Often attend in-class discussions<br>•Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge<br>•Handling questions in a logical way<br>•Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook<br>•Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone) |
| C+, C, C- | •Some participation in discussions<br>•Sometimes attend in-class discussions<br>•Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Fairly address questions as set<br>•Present arguments in a well-structure manner<br>•Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone) |
| D+, D | •Minimal or no participation in discussions<br>•Rarely attend in-class discussions<br>•Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Barely address questions as set<br>•Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner<br>•Respect others and follow the class rules (no chatting and do not use cell phone) |
| F | •Minimal or no participation in discussions<br>•Almost never attend in-class discussions<br>•Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Unable or unwilling to handle questions<br>•Present arguments poorly<br>•Behave poorly in class (often chatting with others, using cell phones, or being late) |
| **Assessment Rubrics for Assignments and the Exam** | |
| A+, A, A- | •Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge<br>•Present arguments that have an element of originality<br>•Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessments with very accurate computation and very good analytical and problem solving skills |
| B+, B, B- | •Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge<br>•Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook<br>•Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessments with accurate computation and good analytical and problem solving skills |
| C+, C, C- | •Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Present arguments in a well-structure manner<br>•Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessments with reasonably accurate computation and acceptable analytical and problem solving skills |
| D+, D | •Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner<br>•Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with some errors in computation and barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills |
| F | •Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved<br>•Present arguments poorly |

| | |
|---|---|
| | •Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessments with major errors in computation and inadequate analytical and problem solving skills |

**COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE**

Class 1: Overview of the wealth management industry and the relevant ecosystem.
Class 2: Family offices: single, multi, and their structure.
Class 3: Tech and how they are relevant to the industry.
Class 4: Family principals: their mindset, investments & what they focus on.
Class 5: Impact investment, ESG & the relevant trends.
Class 6: Entrepreneur & how they factor in the wealth management industries.
Class 7: TBD
Class 8: TBD
Class 9: TBD
Class 10: TBD

**REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS** (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

To be announced on Moodle.

**MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE**

○ Online response via Moodle site

√ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

**COURSE POLICY** (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

**ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION** (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Assignments will be submitted in class before the lectures. No late assignment will be accepted.
Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.
Good questions and discussions on Moodle will be awarded participation grades.